

Hack the Arts

Invent entirely new ways of creating art that wouldn't exist without technology.

About the challenge

Hack The Arts is a global, online hackathon inviting participants to explore how technology can unlock entirely new forms of creative expression. The challenge is centered on the theme: “Create art that couldn’t exist without technology.” Rather than using code as a tool to replicate traditional art, participants are encouraged to build projects that define new artistic mediums through interactivity, computation, and intelligent systems.

Submissions may include generative art, interactive experiences, creative coding tools, AI-assisted artistic workflows, or entirely new forms of digital expression. Strong projects will go beyond static outputs, emphasizing systems that respond, evolve, or engage users in meaningful ways. Participants are encouraged to experiment, take creative risks, and think critically about how technology shapes the way art is created and experienced.

Hack The Arts is open to beginners and experienced builders alike. Whether you are a developer, designer, or artist, the goal is to learn, build, and push the boundaries of what art can be in a digital world.

Get started

1. Register for the hackathon on Devpost and join the [Discord server](#).
2. Form a team of up to four participants or work individually.
3. Brainstorm ideas that align with the theme and explore creative directions.
4. Start building during the official Build Period using any tools, frameworks, or technologies.
5. Attend optional workshops, mentorship sessions, and community events for guidance and inspiration.
6. Submit your project before the deadline, including a demo, source code, and project description.

If you are unsure where to begin, start by thinking about how art could respond to something dynamic, such as sound, movement, data, or user interaction, and build from there.

Requirements

What to Build

Build a project that aligns with the theme: “Create art that couldn’t exist without technology.” Your project should combine code and creativity to produce an interactive, generative, or computational form of art. This may include, but is not limited to, creative coding tools, AI-assisted artistic systems, immersive experiences, data-driven visuals, or experimental digital mediums. Projects should emphasize interactivity, evolution, or user engagement rather than static outputs. All work must be created substantially during the Build Period.

What to Submit

Each submission must include the following:

- A working project demo, provided as a live link or a recorded video
- A publicly accessible source code repository
- A written project description explaining the concept, implementation, and technologies used
- Clear attribution for any third-party assets, libraries, or APIs used

Submissions must be complete and submitted before the deadline. Incomplete, inaccessible, or non-compliant submissions may be disqualified at the organizer’s discretion.

Prizes

\$1,000+ in prizes
+ other prizes

Best Overall Project

\$1,000 in cash
1 winner
Winner will receive \$1000 USD in cash & 2x .xyz domains

Best Interactive Experience

1 winner
2x .xyz domains

Best Beginner Project

1 winner
2x .xyz domains

Most Unique

1 winner
2x .xyz domains

Crowd Favorite

1 winner
2x .xyz domains

Judging Criteria

Creativity & Originality (30%)

Is this a new form of art or interaction?

Use of Technology (25%)

Does the project meaningfully leverage code/AI?

Interactivity & Experience (20%)

Is the project engaging or immersive?

Execution (15%)

How polished and functional is it?

Theme Alignment (10%)

Does it embody “art that couldn’t exist without technology”?

Project and Submission Requirements

Projects must be created during the Build Period. Use of pre-existing code, libraries, frameworks, and APIs is permitted, provided such use is disclosed and properly credited. Each submission must include a working demo (live link or video), a publicly accessible source code repository, and a written project description outlining the concept, implementation, and technologies used. Projects must align with the theme “Create art that couldn’t exist without technology.” Late, incomplete, or non-compliant submissions may be disqualified at the organizer’s discretion.

Prizes

Prizes will be awarded in categories including, but not limited to, Best Overall Project, Crowd Favorite, Most Unique, Best Interactive Experience, and Best Beginner Project. Prizes may include cash awards, sponsor-provided products or credits, and/or non-monetary recognition. All prizes are non-transferable and may be substituted at the organizer’s discretion. Winners are responsible for any applicable taxes and fees.

Judging Criteria and Winner Selection

Eligible submissions will be evaluated by a panel of judges based on the following criteria: Creativity and Originality (30%), Use of Technology (25%), Interactivity and Experience (20%), Execution (15%), and Theme Alignment (10%). Judging decisions are final and binding. The organizer reserves the right not to award a prize in any category if, in its sole discretion, no eligible submission meets the required standards.

[Prize Updates](#)

Hello participants,

We are pleased to announce that we will now be offering \$1000 USD in prize money for the first place winner of the competition! Other prizes will be offered as well, which we will be determining soon.

Questions?

If you have any questions about the hackathon, please post on the [discussion forum](#), reply to this email, or message us in the Discord.

Best,

Avinash | Hack the Arts

<https://hackthearts.devpost.com/>